

Pamoja tena 'Together again'

African linguistics after COVID

Edited by

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Contemporary African Linguistics 14



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Preface

It was a great pleasure to convene the 54th Annual Conference on African Linguistics at the University of Connecticut, Storrs, CT in June of 2023. This was the first in-person ACAL meeting since May of 2019, owing to the COVID-19 pandemic.

In addition to a full program of talks and posters we were delighted to welcome four excellent plenary speakers, two of whom flew in to join us from parts of Africa:

- Quentin Williams, University of the Western Cape:
Toward an African Sociolinguistics of in difference: stance-taking on discrimination
- Eyasu Hailu Tamene, Addis Ababa University:
Towards the official recognition of African sign languages
- Kathryn Franich, Harvard University:
Co-speech gesture and prosodic structure: what African languages can tell us
- Jason Kandybowicz, CUNY Graduate Center:
Escaping African ‘Islands’

The twenty-two papers in this volume were among those presented at the conference. They provide descriptions and analyses of phenomena in a wide range of African languages. The foci include phonetics, phonology, morphology, syntax, semantics, and historical reconstruction. Their empirical basis is in many cases the outcome of painstaking fieldwork to document the myriad under-researched properties of Africa’s linguistic diversity.

We gratefully acknowledge the units here at UConn which provided generous financial support for this conference. Without their funding, ACAL 54 could not have taken place.

- The Department of Linguistics
- The College of Liberal Arts and Sciences

Preface

- The Institute for Brain and Cognitive Sciences
- The Department of Anthropology

We are also very grateful to the efforts of our anonymous reviewers, without whom this proceedings volume would not have been possible.

The editors

June, 2025